STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, June 2, 2025 at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: None.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Commissioner Charisse Fain gave the invocation.

Public comments were heard first. Benny Finch commended the county's EMS staff during a recent medical emergency. He stated that their quick response and outstanding service contributed to his life being saved.

As advertised, a public hearing was held to gain citizen input on the FY 2025-26 proposed budget. The following citizens asked the board to include an increase in the teacher supplement and an increase for certified workers in the upcoming budget: Munirah Ali, Sharita Jones, Jameel Williams, Lindsey Ramsey, Angie Ryan, Mary Susan Williams, and Karen Durham. Lee Chandler supported an increase in the teacher supplement, asked what the surplus is projected to be for the end of the fiscal year, and requested a tax decrease.

As there was no one else who wished to speak on this matter, Chair Carolyn Faines declared the public hearing closed.

Brenda Brown, NC Department of Health and Human Services, appeared before the board and provided an update on the child welfare divestiture at the department of social services. She provided background information and noted that on July 29, 2024, a corrective action plan (CAP) was issued by DHHS which focused on improving safety planning and supervision to ensure protection of children in the county. She noted that even with the CAP in place, DSS failed to ensure the safety and wellbeing of children due to poor management and oversight, as well as failure to hire and maintain staff to manage the day-to-day work and to address deficiencies. As a result, on April 25, 2025, DHHS assumed temporary control of child welfare until these issues are

resolved. She noted that since DHHS assumed control, a staffing plan has been created, 40 high-risk cases have been worked and closed, a back-log team to complete old cases has been created, need assessments have been completed, an in-home services team has been created, etc.

Following discussion, the board thanked Ms. Brown for her report.

Ann Taylor, Piedmont Triad Regional Council, appeared before the board and provided an update on the classification and compensation study. She noted that the study determines if the current pay structure is appropriate or may need to be modified. Areawide counties and municipalities were used to compare to Vance County. The City of Henderson was not included because PTRC did not receive their data on time. She noted that the study is the first step in addressing recruiting and retention issues. The board discussed compression, and Ms. Taylor recommended a separate compression study be performed. She also recommended performance-based increases to avoid compression.

Ms. Taylor stated that the study recommends the following: Implementation of the new pay ranges which increases the current comparative ratio at a minimum to 95% or more of market average; increase employees currently below the new minimum to the minimum of the assigned pay range; and to address compression, adjust employees currently paid above the new minimum by 2.5% per grade.

Following discussion, the board thanked Ms. Taylor for her report.

Amanda Lewis, Council of Governments, was next on the agenda and provided an update on the Digital Inclusion Plan. She noted that the COG was awarded funding from BAND-NC to support the five-county region in developing County Digital Inclusion Plans (DIP) and a Regional Digital Inclusion Plan. A DIP aims to ensure every resident has access to and can effectively use digital technologies. It addresses closing the digital divide by focusing on issues like affordability, connectivity, digital skills, and public computer access. The goal is to promote equal opportunities and participation in the digital age. She provided the following five strategies of the DIP:

1. That all North Carolinians have access to high-speed internet and affordable, low-cost internet services.
2. To promote practices that support online accessibility and inclusiveness of public resources and services.
3. To ensure that North Carolinians can acquire digital skills and understanding to meet their personal needs and the workforce needs of the state.
4. To promote practices and leverage tools to ensure online privacy and security.
5. To ensure that North Carolinians have access to digital devices to meet their needs.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., to approve the updated Digital Inclusion Plan as presented.

Elections Chair James Baines and Elections Director Haley Rawles appeared before the board and provided information on voting location changes. Ms. Rawles informed the board that due to low voter turnout at certain locations, 12 precincts have been merged down to 9 precincts. She noted that North Henderson 1 and East Henderson 1 will merge and create Central Henderson, with the voting site being the old Eaton-Johnson Middle School on Beckford Drive. Also, Hilltop, South Henderson 1, and South Henderson 2 will merge and create South Henderson, with the voting site being the Perry Memorial Library on Breckenridge Street.

KARTS Director Randy Cantor and DSS Director Sandy Weaver appeared before the board to discuss the management of Rural Operating Assistance Program (ROAP) funding. Mr. Cantor explained that the ROAP is an offering of the NC Department of Transportation to assist public transportation systems with operating funds designed to assist specific individuals with access to affordable transportation as follows:

- Rural General Public (RGP). Assists anyone within the rural service area.
- Employment (EMPL). Assists anyone within the service area with access to employment or vocational training.
- Elderly/Disabled Transportation Assistance Program (EdTap). Assists anyone 60 years of age or older, or anyone with a verifiable disability.

He noted that operation and administrative grants are applied for and reimbursed after the services have been completed. Funds for ROAP usage are dispersed with the only expectation being that the usage is reported monthly. Any funds not used are subtracted from the next year's allotment with the current year's unspent portion rolled over to the next year. These lost funds will not be replaced.

Mr. Cantor stated that currently KARTS is responsible for completing the application process to request these funds. Once approved the funds are sent to the counties which are then responsible for reporting this usage to KARTS so it can be reported to the state. KARTS will then invoice each county for the RGP and EMPL funds. EdTap funds are left to the counties' discretion but must be reported on in a timely manner. KARTS is required by the state to report this information every month. He stated that in order to simplify this process, he requested that KARTS be the recipient of all future ROAP allotments. With KARTS' new scheduling software, they can track by county usage and costs closely and report on time to the state. He noted that he will be

requesting the same from Granville, Franklin and Warren counties. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that she supports this request. The board thanked Mr. Cantor for his report.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to allow KARTS to retain and manage ROAP funding effective July 1, 2025. This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

Special Projects Coordinator Frankie Nobles appeared before the board and provided an update on repairs and cleaning at the detention center. This included repairs of doors, showers, toilets, fire alarm, etc. Replacement of HVAC filters, generator coolants, exhaust fans, ceiling tiles, etc. He noted that repairs are about 50% complete. It was noted that all repairs have taken place since Administration took over the maintenance of the facility from the Sheriff's Office. The board thanked Mr. Nobles and the maintenance staff for getting this work done so quickly. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt requested the cost of these repairs to date.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order.

As advertised, a public hearing was held to gain citizen input on the FY 2025-26 proposed budget of the Vance County Water District. As there was no one present who wished to speak on this matter, Chair Faines declared the public hearing closed.

The April 2025 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that the city has increased its water rates by 6.8%. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Finance Director's Report

Fiscal Year-End Closeout Authorization. Finance Director Stephanie Williams stated that in order to finalize the county's FY 2024-25 books and conduct appropriate closeout transactions, it is necessary to obtain board approval for the required budget actions.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to authorize staff to perform the necessary FY 2024-25 year-end budgeting and accounting transactions.

Budget Amendment #41
FY 2024-2025
Year End Closeout

DESCRIPTION:	ACCOUNT	AMOUNT *(FROM ACCOUNT)*	AMOUNT *(TO ACCOUNT)*
Group Insurance	10-610-500006	186,300	
Low Income Home Energy Assist	10-610-500433	500,000	
Crisis Intervention	10-610-500235	200,000	
Contracted Services	10-610-500045	100,000	
Medical Examiner	10-525-500174		4,000
Food & Provisions	10-520-500047		25,000
Special Contracted Services	10-520-500044		65,000
Health Care-Drugs-Medicine	10-520-500046		100,000
Special Contracted Services	10-470-500044		15,300
Special Contracted Services	10-520-500044		38,000
Pest Control	10-520-500057		750
Departmental Supplies	10-520-500033		8,250
Capital Projects	10-696-500075		730,000
Fuel	10-530-500186	15,100.63	
Fuel	10-520-500186	15,000	
Fuel	10-510-500186	15,000	
Medical Examiner	10-525-500174		12,950
Special Contracted Services	10-619-500044		17,847.18
Other Supplies & Materials	10-619-500034		8,311.08
Auto Supplies	10-620-500031		15.07
Special Contracted Services	10-620-500044		5,962.24
Auto Supplies	10-620-500031		15.06
Contingency	10-999-500099	17,070	
Medical Examiner	10-525-500174		5,700
Capital Outlay	10-440-500074		11,370
½ Sales Tax – 30% Schools	10-345-434502	25,457.06	
½ Add'l Sales Tax Schools	10-345-434504	59,399.82	
CR-Schools	10-696-500033		84,856.88
Telephone & Postage	10-555-500011	483.00	
Special Projects	10-604-500062		483.00
Departmental Supplies	10-555-500033	12.43	
Credit Card/EBT Reimb.	10-622-500044		12.43
Capital Outlay	10-510-500074	33,112.90	
Capital Projects	10-696-500075		33,112.90
Special Contracted Services	10-450-500044	2,581.32	
Special Contracted Services	10-470-500044		2,581.32
Dues & Subscription	10-605-500053	52.91	
Travel/Training	10-604-500014		8.00
4-H Farm Bureau Expense	10-604-500405		44.91
Fund Balance Appropriated	16-399-439900	211,316.47	
Contracted Services	16-665-500045		81,316.47
Depreciation Expense	16-665-500390		130,000
Capital Outlay	10-530-500074	17,520	
Capital Projects	10-696-500075		17520
Group Insurance	10-510-500006	200,000	
Group Insurance	10-530-500006	150,000	
Group Insurance	10-531-500006	50,000	
Group Insurance	10-621-500006	100,000	
MERP Revenue	72-350-500001		500,000
Fines & Forfeiture Revenue	76-360-435601	150,462.71	
Fines & Forfeiture Expense	76-500-500011		150,462.71

Quarterly Financial Report. Finance Director Stephanie Williams provided the quarterly financial report which outlined year-to-date revenues and expenditures and the comparison of each amount to the budget as amended. She also provided expenses by category.

Assistant County Manager's Report

Fireworks Permit – City of Henderson. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones stated that the City of Henderson is requesting approval for a fireworks permit for a fireworks display at Fox Pond Park on Saturday, June 28 (June 29 - rain date). The display will be contracted with a professional pyrotechnics firm (Zambelli Fireworks Mfg. Co.) which has the appropriate credentials and insurance coverage. The county fire marshal has approved the permit subject to board approval. Recommendation: Approve the request from the City of Henderson and Zambelli Fireworks Mfg. Co. for a permit to discharge fireworks at Fox Pond Park on Saturday, June 28, 2025 (rain date - June 29).

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve the request from the City of Henderson and Zambelli Fireworks Mfg. Co. for a permit to discharge fireworks at Fox Pond Park on Saturday, June 28, 2025 (rain date - June 29). This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

National End Gun Violence Awareness Day Proclamation. Mr. Jones noted that National Gun Violence Awareness Day is on June 6, the first Friday of the month. The day marks the start of "Wear Orange Weekend", which takes place on June 7 and 8. Wear Orange is a campaign to raise awareness about gun violence and demand change. Recommendation: Approve the proclamation recognizing National End Gun Violence Awareness Day and proclaim June 6, 2025 to be Wear Orange Day in Vance County.

Motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the following proclamation recognizing National End Gun Violence Awareness Day and proclaim June 6, 2025 to be Wear Orange Day in Vance County.

P R O C L A M A T I O N
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
in recognition of
National End Gun Violence Awareness Day

WHEREAS, many Americans are killed by gun violence every day and on average there are nearly 13,000 gun homicides every year; and

WHEREAS, Americans are 25 times more likely to be killed with guns than people in other high-income countries; and

WHEREAS, in January 2013, Hadiya Pendleton, a teenager who marched in President Obama's second inaugural parade was tragically shot and killed just weeks later; and

WHEREAS, after her death, her family and friends chose to wear orange on her birthday to honor her and the thousands of lives lost to gun violence every year; and

WHEREAS, in October 2016, Ahmad Campbell, a former Southern Vance High School student who was 21 years old at the time and a college junior at North Carolina A&T University, was tragically shot and killed while attending an off-campus party; and

WHEREAS, to honor Ahmad, his family created the Ahmad Campbell Foundation, a non-profit organization that provides Ahmad and Alisia Scholarships annually for students continuing their education; and

WHEREAS, June 6, 2025 is National End Gun Violence Awareness Day, also known as Wear Orange Day, when gun violence prevention supporters and advocates across the country wear orange to honor the victims of gun violence and show support for the gun safety movement.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize National End Gun Violence Awareness Day and proclaims June 6, 2025 to be Wear Orange Day in Vance County.

This, the 2nd day of June, 2025.

Carolyn Faines **(signed)**
Carolyn Faines, Chair

County Manager's Report

County Manager C. Renee Perry reported that the City of Henderson has elected not to enter into a 50/50 agreement with the county for code enforcement which would allow the county to perform inspections within the city limits. Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. expressed his concerns with this and questioned what would happen to those permits that have already been approved for inspections. Ms. Perry responded that the county's chief code enforcement officer has been in discussions with the city's development services director to develop a plan to move forward. Commissioner Hester stated that he still has concerns. County Attorney Jonathan Care stated that the county has offered to do the inspections, but the city is not willing to split the costs 50/50. There is not much further the county can do at this point.

MOU - Youth Services Use of Eaton Johnson Gym. Ms. Perry stated that Vance County and the City of Henderson have drafted a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) allowing the Henderson-Vance Parks and Recreation Department to use the Eaton Johnson gym exclusively for youth programming. The agreement prohibits the facility's use for rentals or non-youth-

related events. The county will provide utilities and maintain the building's major systems and structure, while the city is responsible for day-to-day upkeep, security, and cleaning. The MOU is effective upon execution and will run through June 30, 2025, automatically renewing for one year unless either party provides 30 days' notice. She noted that the county retains priority use in case of emergencies or election needs. The city must carry $1 million in liability insurance and list the county as an additional insured. Either party may terminate the agreement with 30 days' notice. Recommendation: Approve the recommended youth services memorandum of understanding effective June 2, 2025 between the city and county for use of the Eaton Johnson gym.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the memorandum of understanding effective June 2, 2025 between the city and county for use of the Eaton Johnson gym.

MOU - Youth Services Cost Share Addendum. Ms. Perry stated that at the request of the city's auditors, the city has requested this addendum effective June 2, 2025. It outlines the continued partnership between Vance County and the City of Henderson for the joint operation of certain community and youth services programs.

Key terms include:

- The Youth Services Outreach Division (formerly Friends of Youth), which oversees programs such as Y-NYPUM, Community Service, and Restitution will be 100% funded by the county, net of any revenues.
- For other shared services covered under the original agreement, dated September 10, 1991, the costs will be split on a 55% City / 45% County basis.
- The City will invoice the County monthly for its pro-rata share, and for the Youth Services Outreach Division, invoices will reflect 100% reimbursement from the county.

Recommendation: Approve the youth services cost share addendum between the city and county effective June 2, 2025.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the youth services cost share addendum between the city and county effective June 2, 2025.

Budget Direction/Follow-Up. Ms. Perry requested direction on several items from the May 20, 2025 budget work session as follows.

Volunteer Fire Department Funding – Substations/Fire Tax Rate. Ms. Perry referenced a request from the Vance County Fire Association in 2023 to keep the fire tax rate at 8.9 cents. She asked if this is something the board wishes to do.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that there are more elements to the budget other than the fire tax. He does not agree with action being taken on the budget at this time. Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. suggested that the rate be an even 9 cents.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to set the fire tax rate at 9 cents in the upcoming budget. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and vote was ayes – six (6); noes – one (1), with the dissenting vote being cast by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt.

Salary Study Implementation – Alternatives. Ms. Perry asked for direction on whether or not to budget for the salary study implementation. There was discussion on waiting until January 2026 to begin the implementation and possibly splitting it between two fiscal years. She provided information on what surrounding counties are budgeting for COLAs and merit increases. Ms. Perry recommended a 3% COLA for the upcoming budget if the board decides to wait until January 2026 for the salary study. The board agreed to this and will discuss further during its next budget work session on June 16.

Capital Reserve – Community College. Ms. Perry asked the board for direction on whether or not to create a capital reserve fund for the community college. It was noted during the last budget work session that Granville County has a capital reserve fund and has contributed $400,000 per year for the last two years. She recommended creating an account and allocating $500,000 in the upcoming budget. The board agreed to create this account and will discuss further during the budget work session on June 16.

Consent Agenda

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: April 2025 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the May 5, 2025 regular meeting and the May 20, 2025 budget work session.

TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR APRIL 2025

TAXPAYER NAME	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	SOLID WASTE FEE	REASON
BLACKWELL RONNIE	2024	$0.00	$18.28	125	PERS PROP BILLED
BLAKE KELLEY NORWOOD	2024	$0.00	$99.12	0	PERS PROP BILLED
FISHER OF MEN CHURCH OF OUR	2024	$151.91	$0.00	0	RELIGIOUS
MINTZER ERIN	2024	$144.42	$0.00	0	CORRECT VALUE
OVERBY BRITTANY MICHELLE	2024	$0.00	$144.52	0	PERS PROP BILLED

PERNELL RONNIE D	2024	$0.00	$19.64	125	PERS PROP BILLED
PERSON NATHAN JR	2024	$352.11	$0.00	0	CORRECT VALUE
SPRING VALLEY METHODIST CHURCH	2024	$203.55	$0.00	0	RELIGIOUS
TAYLOR CHARLES R	2024	$0.00	$101.96	125	PERS PROP BILLED
TERRY CHRISTOPHER ONEAL	2024	$0.00	$86.96	0	PERS PROP BILLED
HOUSE OF TOYZ INC	2025	$0.00	$122.27	0	CORRECT VALUE
HOUSE OF TOYZ INC	2025	$0.00	$0.37	0	CORRECT VALUE
HOUSE OF TOYZ INC	2025	$0.00	$1.50	0	CORRECT VALUE
TERRY CHRISTOPHER ONEAL	2025	$0.00	$72.26	0	PERS PROP BILLED
		TOTAL	TOTAL		
		$851.99	$666.88		

MONTHLY REPORTS: 911 Emergency Operations, Administrative Ambulance Charge-Offs, Cooperative Extension, EMS, Fire Department, Fire Marshal, Human Resources, Information Technology, Parks and Recreation, Planning and Development, Tax Collections, and Veterans Service.

Miscellaneous

Appointments. The following appointments were presented to the board for consideration:

Henderson-Vance Recreation Commission – four-year term
Reappoint Ed Wilson

Jury Commission – two-year term
Reappoint Eddie Vick

Vance-Granville Community College Board of Trustees – four-year term
Reappoint Carolyn Faines

Kerr-Tar Workforce Development Board – two-year term
Reappoint Ryan Randall

Social Services Board – three-year term
Two applications received from Yolanda Feimster and Valencia Perry to fill position currently held by Archie Taylor. Mr. Taylor has requested that he be allowed to remain in this position until June 30, 2025.

Commissioners Hester and Brummitt agreed to allow Archie Taylor to remain on the Social Services Board until June 30, 2025. County Attorney Jonathan Care recommended that the board defer this appointment until such time the board is ready to name a replacement.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to defer the appointment to the Social Services Board until such time the board is ready to name a replacement. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. and unanimously approved.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve all other appointments as presented.

Appointment of NACo Voting Delegate. Motion was made by Commissioner Yolanda Feimster to appoint Charisse Fain as the voting delegate for the NACo Annual Conference. This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

As there was no further business, at 8:30 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed September 2, 2025.

***Carolyn Faines* (signed)**
Carolyn Faines, Chair